

Hearth OS

Progress report · version 0.21.0 · 29 September 2026

Hearth OS turns a living-room PC into a TV-style home screen for Steam, emulation, streaming apps and Quick Resume, driven by a controller, a TV remote or a Wii Remote. It's built on Bazzite and installs as a system image that updates itself and can always be rolled back. It runs on AMD and Intel graphics; NVIDIA is left for later.

13,506

lines of code

334

automated tests

21

versions released

22

pull requests merged

11

guides in docs/

Since 0.20.0: code +973, tests +22. Tested on: Ryzen 7 5800X3D, Radeon RX 6750 XT, 24 GB, 256 GB SATA SSD, Xbox controller, Wii Remotes on a DolphinBar.

What's new in 0.21.0

- **Captures:** take a screenshot of whatever's playing from the Quick Menu (System → Take a screenshot) or with *hearthctl screenshot*. A Captures tile shows them all: view one full screen, flip through, delete ones you don't want. They're kept in your Pictures folder, named after the game.
- **Your screenshots in the screen saver**, mixed in with your games' art.
- **What's new:** after an update, the home screen shows once what the new version brought (like this).
- **Network by the clock:** Wi-Fi signal bars, a plug when wired, or "offline" when there's no connection.
- **A simpler install guide** and a **hardware compatibility** list: AMD and Intel graphics are supported; NVIDIA is left for later.
- **A progress report for every version**, with lines of code, tests and what's working, in *reports/*.

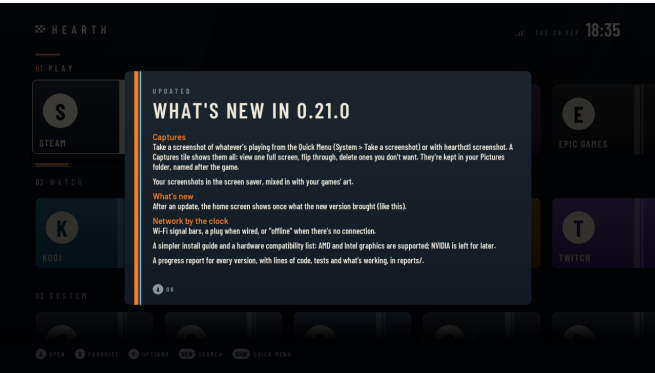
What's working

Area	What it does	Status
Home screen	TV-style rows, liveries, a backdrop from the focused game, controller batteries and network by the clock	Confirmed on the PC
Emulation	ES-DE with a tile per console; emulators tuned for the GPU and TV	Confirmed on the PC (Dolphin working)
Wii Remote	DolphinBar pointer on the home screen and as a mouse; handed to Dolphin for Wii games	Confirmed on the PC (pointer working)
Quick Resume	Hold Guide to pause a game and pick it up later (up to 3)	Shipped
Quick Menu	Guide button panel: audio, per-app volume, Discord, stats, power, updates, screenshots	Shipped
Streaming	YouTube (VacuumTube), Twitch (VacuumStream), Kodi, Jellyfin, Plex, Moonlight	Shipped
Game stores	Epic Games (Heroic) and Battle.net (Lutris) tiles; their games in the Library	Shipped
Customising	Favorites with X, move tiles, hide tiles, liveries, sounds	Shipped
Search and details	Search every app and game; Y on a game for play time and last played	Shipped
Settings	Wi-Fi, static IP and DNS, Bluetooth, audio devices, storage (format and use a new drive)	Shipped

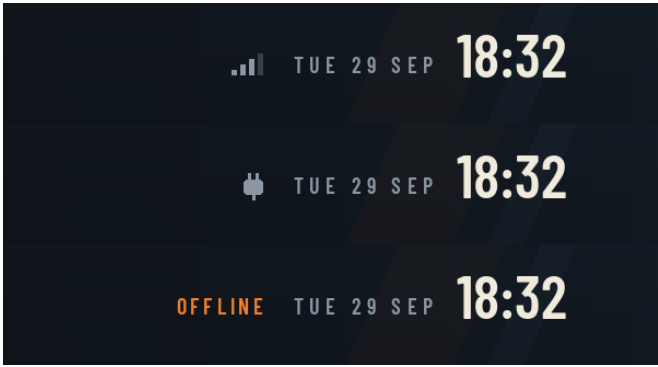
Area	What it does	Status
Captures	Screenshots from the Quick Menu, a gallery tile, in the screen saver	Shipped
Updates	Automatic, versioned, with releases on GitHub, a what's-new card and rollback	Shipped
Phone as a remote	A web page with a d-pad and keyboard, paired with a code on the TV	Not started
Profiles, folders	Per-person favorites; groups of tiles	Not started (deferred for now)
NVIDIA graphics	A separate image with NVIDIA's driver	Not started (deferred: AMD and Intel first)
Netflix and similar	DRM limits these to low quality on any home-built PC	Not possible

Confirmed means reported working on the real PC; Shipped means built, tested and released, but not yet reported on.

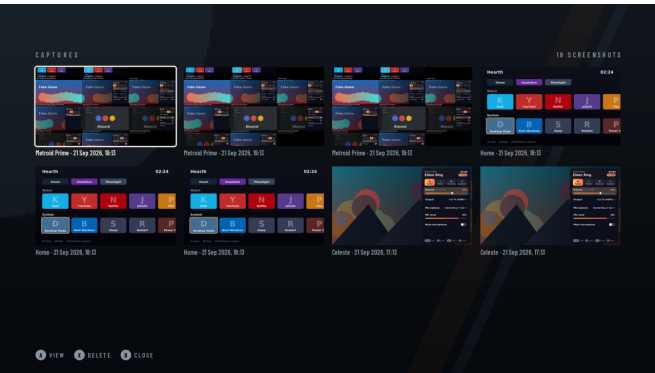
Screenshots



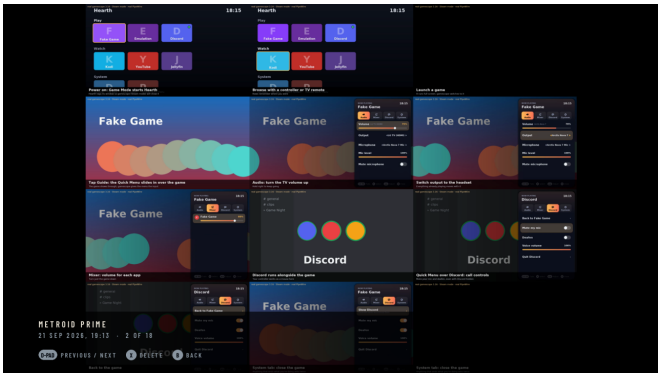
What's new: shown once after an update.



By the clock: Wi-Fi bars, wired, or offline.



The Captures tile: every screenshot, newest first.

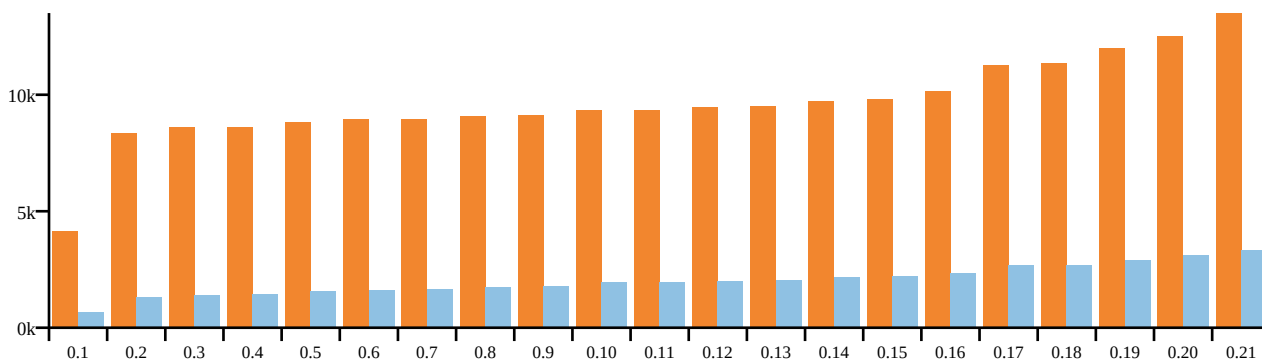


One screenshot full screen, with delete.

Lines of code by part

Part	Lines
Home screen, Quick Menu and settings (Python)	11,053
System image (scripts, services, config)	1,071
Build and tools	1,382
Tests	4,661

Growth



Lines of code (orange) and automated tests (blue, $\times 10$) at each version.

Open issues

Issue	Where it stands	What's needed
Steam "Switch to Desktop" can still hang	Holding Guide for 4 s always gets you home; the cause isn't known	hearthctl status and hearthctl logs right after it happens
Recent updates not yet tried on the PC	Built and tested in a virtual display	Update, then try the checklist in the release notes

Next

- Your phone as a remote, with a keyboard for search and Wi-Fi passwords.
- Fix what turns up on the real PC.
- When wanted: profiles and groups of tiles; NVIDIA support.

Every version

Version	Date	Lines of code	Tests	Docs (lines)	Pull requests
0.21.0	2026-09-29	13,506	334	1,382	22
0.20.0	2026-09-29	12,533	312	1,260	20
0.19.0	2026-09-29	11,984	291	1,120	19
0.18.0	2026-09-29	11,370	270	1,067	18
0.17.0	2026-09-29	11,288	268	1,034	17
0.16.0	2026-09-29	10,159	233	1,022	16
0.15.0	2026-09-29	9,817	223	971	15
0.14.0	2026-09-29	9,741	218	969	14
0.13.0	2026-09-29	9,507	205	954	13
0.12.0	2026-09-27	9,474	201	954	12
0.11.0	2026-09-27	9,339	195	953	11
0.10.0	2026-09-27	9,326	194	940	10
0.9.0	2026-09-27	9,111	179	906	9
0.8.0	2026-09-27	9,072	173	904	8
0.7.0	2026-09-27	8,970	165	901	7
0.6.0	2026-09-27	8,931	163	901	6
0.5.0	2026-09-27	8,836	157	897	5
0.4.0	2026-09-27	8,598	144	888	4
0.3.0	2026-09-27	8,597	141	886	3
0.2.0	2026-09-27	8,336	132	865	2
0.1.0	2026-09-25	4,155	66	703	1